economic assistance and PL 480 funds do not indenture a nation, there is less reason why military aid should.'[64]

Further, the Swatantra Party viewed communism – especially Chinese – not Western colonialism or racialism as the major threat to global peace. Thus, it did not support the idea of a third front of developing countries standing up to the two cold war blocs. For the Swatantra Party non-alignment neither helped India achieve its national interests nor helped India make friends. According to C. Rajagopalachari, 'never have we been more abandoned by friends and menaced by foes thanks to our airy foreign policy' and hence 'it is time to discard non-alignment, for it not only does not insure our national security but in fact imperils our domestic economy'. [65]

In Rajagopalachari's view, Western colonialism was 'a "dead horse" which Swatantra declines to beat, and Angola, Rhodesia, et al. are far from its concerns; communist colonialism, especially that of China, is the clear and present danger; racialism is of little concern; non-alignment is held to be both militarily and economically suicidal; the notions of a third force and of mediation in the "cold war" fall to the ground once alignment is accepted; and this receives further impetus from the conviction that the truth lies with the Western democracies'. [66]

The Swatantra Party died a slow death by 1974 because of lacklustre leadership and an inability to generate a mass following. Its electoral performance was far from impressive. However, another conservative movement, rooting itself in Hindu (as opposed to Nehru's secular Indian) nationalism, has managed to survive through various incarnations all the way to the present-day Bharatiya Janata Party (literally Indian Peoples Party). Inspired by the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS – National Volunteer Organization), an ideological movement seeking revival of Hindu identity and culture, the Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS) (literally Indian Peoples Association) was the first major incarnation of Hindu nationalist